THE .C3ADDON FILE

View online: https://www.construct.net/en/make-games/manuals/addon-sdk/guide/c3addon-file

Construct 3 addons are distributed as a .c3addon file. This is simply a .zip file renamed to end with .c3addon. You can rename a .c3addon file to .zip and inspect its contents, or create a .c3addon file by zipping some files and renaming it.

> *Make sure all the files are at the root level of the zip. If you accidentally place all files in a subfolder inside the zip, you'll get the error "missing addon.json" when trying to install it in Construct, because it expects to find that file at the root level.*

Structure of a .c3addon file

The files in a .c3addon for a plugin are arranged as follows. Note some features allow extra files to be added, but this is the minimal file structure for an empty plugin/behavior.

- **c3runtime/** — subfolder for Construct 3 runtime files.
- **lang/en-US.json** — language file containing strings shown in the user interface. This is kept in a separate file to facilitate translation.
- **aces.json** — JSON data file that defines actions, conditions and expressions.
- **addon.json** — JSON data file with metadata about the addon.
- **icon.svg** — addon icon.
- **plugin.js** or **behavior.js** — class representing the plugin or behavior.
- **type.js** — class representing an object type of the plugin, or behavior type of the behavior, in the editor.
- **instance.js** — class representing an instance of the plugin, or behavior instance of the behavior, in the editor.

Specifying metadata

The basic metadata about your addon, such as its ID and type, is set in **addon.json**. See Addon metadata for more information.

Setting plugin information

For plugins, the detailed information about the plugin and its capabilities is set in **plugin.js**. See Configuring plugins for more information.

Setting behavior information

For behaviors, the detailed information about the behavior and its capabilities is set in **behavior.js**. See Configuring behaviors for more information.

Setting effect information

For effects, the detailed information about the effect and its capabilities is set using extra properties in **addon.json**. The effect itself is written in a **.fx** file. See Configuring effects for more information.

Defining actions, conditions and expressions

To define your plugin or behavior's actions, conditions and expressions (ACEs), they must be specified in **aces.json** and the corresponding language strings added in **en-US.json**. (Currently the language file must be in US English, but the fact it is in a separate file will help facilitate translation in future.)

For more information see Defining actions, conditions and expressions.